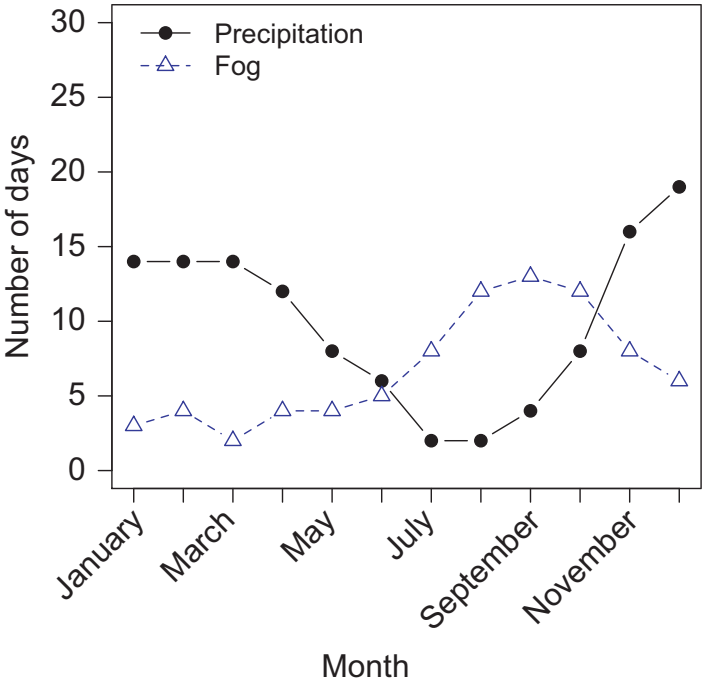
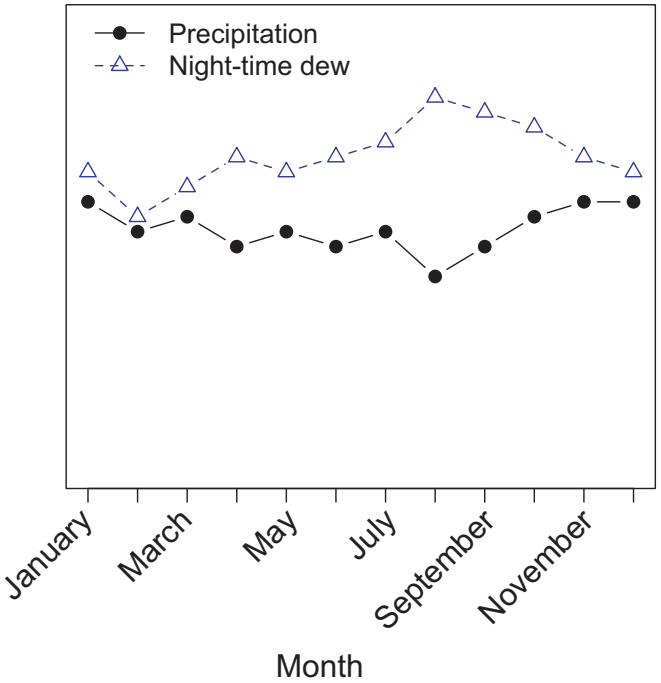
Seasonal variation in precipitation events resulting in leaf wetting in a coastal redwood ecosystem in California (left panel) and an agricultural grassland in the Netherlands (right panel).




Both ecosystems are subject to additional leaf wetting by either fog or dewfall. In both systems, this hidden, or 'occult,' precipitation acts as a subsidy to winter rainfall and can have its greatest impact during an otherwise dry summer. Data adapted from Dawson (1998) (redwoods) and Jacobs *et al.* (2006) (grassland).